



The most popular security suite

2012 suites: Faster, slimmer, more effective

Security Software Suites have evolved over the last few years. As malware has become more sophisticated, so have security suites. One interesting trend is the inclusion of digital sandboxes, which work by executing unknown applications in protected memory to detect any malicious behavior before allowing the application to access the system. Another innovation is application-stamping, where known good applications are whitelisted, allowing the anti-malware software/firewall to skip rescanning the applications whenever they are launched. That helps to speed up application launches and minimise the CPU cycles needed by the security software.

Another emerging trend in fighting malware is the use of cloud computing: The security suite on your PC enlists the



The most popular anti-virus software

power of the software maker's massive online systems to help detect threats. Some anti-malware packages use cloud computing to supplement other detection technology. What's more, security software vendors are becoming more proactive about protecting your PC, especially when it comes to updating signatures. Many of the products here check for new signatures several times a day, which is helpful for combating zero-day threats from new exploits. 